

Digital Citizen Reflection

Turning online habits into evidence and action

Mina Soliman

Signal & Self



Evidence and its limits

WHO survey: 11% showed signs of problematic social media use

Almost 280,000 young people, ages 11, 13 and 15. Surveyed in 2022.

UNESCO: a framework for judging information

Guidance helps us ask better questions. A specific claim still needs its own evidence.

WHO (2024) and UNESCO media literacy resources. Sources in speaker notes.



The four-step framework

- 1 Observe** What happens, in what context?
- 2 Evaluate** What does the evidence support?
- 3 Identify** What risk matters? What benefit stays?
- 4 Act** What will I try, check, and review?



Observe: the news-sharing habit

FICTIONAL NEWS EXAMPLE

A friend posts a cropped screenshot claiming city buses will be free next month.

The date and original announcement are missing.

What do you do online?

I almost share a viral post saying our city's buses will be free next month.

Describe one habit; avoid names or private details.

Screenshot backup of the working activity



Evaluate: what supports the claim?

FICTIONAL NEWS EXAMPLE

An original source and a date

Media literacy guidance helps us look for missing context.

Neither card verifies this fictional bus claim.

UNESCO

Judging information before using it

Date: Publication date not stated; checked 2026-10-04

UNESCO describes media literacy as the skills needed to engage critically with information and navigate digital environments safely.

▼ [Who it covers & what it cannot tell us](#)

Population / audience: General media and information literacy guidance for people engaging with information online.

Limit: This is educational guidance, not an experiment measuring how much a particular checking routine improves accuracy.

Who made the claim, what original evidence supports it, and what context is missing?

[Read the original source](#)



Identify: the risk and the benefit

FICTIONAL NEWS EXAMPLE

Risk

Sharing a claim without evidence

Benefit to preserve

Helping friends find useful transport information

3 · Identify a risk

What risk do you want to address?

Sharing a claim without evidence

Describe the risk (optional)

Use this to add context or describe your own risk.

What benefit do you want to keep?

Helping friends find useful transport information.

A change can preserve connection, creativity, learning, or another benefit you value.

Screenshot backup of the working activity



Act: a change we can check

FICTIONAL NEWS EXAMPLE

Find a dated transit-agency announcement before forwarding.

For the next three posts, record whether an original source was available.

Review in seven days.

Your action plan

Fictional example action plan - edited examples remain fictional

Topic

News & information

Observe

I almost share a viral post saying our city's buses will be free next month.

Context

A friend shares a cropped screenshot in a group chat.

What I notice

The screenshot has no date or link to an official announcement.

Evidence and its limits

Media literacy guidance helps me ask for the original source and context. Neither source here verifies this fictional bus claim.

Risk

Sharing a claim without evidence.

Benefit to keep

Helping friends find useful transport information.

Change to try

Find a dated transit-agency announcement before forwarding the claim. If I cannot verify it, say that clearly.

Check progress

For the next three news posts I consider sharing, record whether I found an original source.

Review date

2025-10-11

Edit my answers

Download text

Print action plan

Keep the benefit. Try the change. Review what actually happened.

Screenshot backup of the working activity



Your two-minute reflection

Choose one habit or one fictional example

Screen time and attention / Social media and privacy
News and information / AI-assisted tools

Write the risk, the benefit, and one change you could try.

How would you check it? When would you review it?



Development lessons

Sources need their limits beside them

Private answers need a deliberate save choice

Draft recovery and keyboard access need testing



One change, then a review

Observe. Evaluate. Identify. Act.

Keep the benefit. Try the change.
Review what actually happened.

mini34.github.io/signal-and-self/

